Heya, below it's the doc you can use to guide yourself to weaken and break craving.

While you might have another honeymoon phase after weakening craving, please rest assured you need at least 2 (or more, like in my case) big inquiry cycles e.g. working out some big issues.

In my case, it was stuff around personal relationships (family/partners) both for weakening and breaking, with breaking being done around '*what if i never had a relationship ever again*'. Fun times!

Helpful videos for craving:

- Fetters Model website (i've used it to weaken Desire/Ill Will on my own as well): https://www.simplytheseen.com/fetters-45-guide.html
- Interview with Kevin from Simply The Seen and Angelo Dilulo on Fetters 4-5: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=eye33kD4uSI&t=321s&ab_channel=SimplyAlwaysAwake
- Understanding the process of reactivity/craving through 1st dart-2nd dart analogy: https://www.tjwaldorf.com/first-and-second-darts-the-darts-we-throw-ourselves
- Great video on suffering reduction from Frank Yang, worth watching: https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=h2PQE7WZhDQ&ab_channel=FrankYang

Theory time!

We'll be basing this inquiry in the notion of the two darts analogy that Buddha shared.
By that we understand the 1st dart being the sensations we cannot avoid (e.g. stubbing your toe on the furniture) and the 2nd dart we create ourselves (e.g. getting angry crappy stuff always happens to use, throwing furniture around).

> **First Dart:** Per an expression from Buddha, "the inescapable physical or mental discomfort is the "first dart" of existence."
>
> **Second Dart(s):** Our reactions to first darts. These are the darts we tend to throw ourselves. Most of our suffering comes from second darts.

So here's something i've worked with. My father loves giving advice (funnily enough i do too, but it took parsing this to realize) and that triggered my 'frustration' button, not wanting to be hearing whatever theory he has at the time.

Factually, what happened, is that my father said a bunch of sentences, which made some unpleasant initial sensations appear in my body. Because i didn't want to feel those sensations, i imagine that there's this 'frustration' button that he triggers (or the reason i got angry) and turn into overthinking, arguing and suffering (feeling like shit).

You only get about 8-10 words to describe a situation you're trying to reduce the craving on, no adjectives, only facts, such as that someone else, like me, would be

able to see what you see and not leave room for interpretation. (that my father's advice is innervating was a personal craving, some might find him endearing).

For the situation below: '.**'my father gave me advice and triggered my 'frustration' button**

WHERE IS THAT BUTTON IN YOUR DIRECT EXPERIENCE, CAN YOU FIND SUCH A BUTTON?

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Algorithm for weakening reactivity:

- start with the story
- eliminate the narrative and take what's factual e.g. what's desired and not available
- intone the sentence
- locate the sensations in the body
- ask yourself how bad are these from 1-10?
- now look more carefully really, how bad are they compared to breaking a leg?
- reintone the sentence
- create a gap by intentionally keeping the thoughts at bay and staying with the sensations
- ask yourself: so what? why react? is there a button/trigger/reason to react?
- feel the sensations while widening the gap
- compared to when you started the inquiry, what's the intensity like? lower, same, higher?
- you'll know it's done once the sentence feels factual as if "my body is 70% water"

Test for reactivity by creating a gap with no sentence and see if any thoughts or narratives try to take you away from direct experience

(Add a step if needed to either spill out for 2 minutes all thoughts that come out or if working on their own to write out)

The 3 ways to create the gap:
- freeze sensations
- repeat sentence
- anchor yourself to the room and notice sensations are 1% of experiential field
- label the mental chatter as just "thought"-"thought"

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After intoning, out loud or in your inner world, such a sentence, you would stay with the initial, crappy sensations, and with the gap that appears between them and the reaction (e.g. plenty of thoughts, feeling like heating up in anger).

NOTE: in some issues, you haven't gotten to the bottom of the issue e.g. the frustration might turn into 'misunderstanding' button or something else. That means you work with the new button, BUT don't use this shifting-button not to sit with the initial sensations as that's the whole point.

Supporting exercises

>>>1.
To separate out a bit more what is 'primary' suffering and what is 'secondary', something that is inherently painful - (often called "first arrow" in Buddhist teachings) like a sore thumb after knocking it with a hammer, or hearing a piece of news that's sad about someone you love (e.g. pain, illness, loss)….and secondary suffering (or "second arrow"), which is the emotional and mental proliferation/anguish etc. that we often add on to this.

At root, the mind is spinning a story, often boiling down to 'it shouldn't be like this' or 'this shouldn't be happening', or just 'I don't want this'. Along with this there is the emotional side of it - usually some kind of painful or uncomfortable contraction in the body.

Exercise:
Please write two separate lists, one of your direct experiences of 'primary suffering' and one of 'secondary suffering', e.g.

My leg hurts when I walk "Oh no! Will I be crippled for life?"
I have a cough "Damn!There's something wrong with me."

My left hand is numb when I sit in bed	Is that a heart issue? What If I have some undiagnosed problem? Should I call a doctor in the middle of the night
Raluca doesn't listen to what I'm communicating	She thinks I'm being confrontational with her and keeps raising her voice at me
My friends decided to end their relationship	I can't believe people that seemed happy broke up, if they can't have a happy relationship how can i?
I haven't posted content online	There's something wrong with me, maybe it's because what I have to say it's not interesting enough

NOTE: WRITE DOWN LIKE 10-15 OF THESE, SITUATIONS WHERE YOU FEEL NOT ACCEPTING/CRAVING SOMETHING MORE/REACTING TO UNPLEASANT CURRENT SENSATIONS

Then write the story in factual manner as above e.g.

"X has said this thing and that triggered my annoyance button".

"I saw X at Y place and that triggered my 'loneliness' button".

Sit with awareness of any kind of suffering (sensations or thoughts+emotions) that is 'here' now. The direct experience and sense of it.
Where is it happening?
What form is it taking?
Describe any differences you notice between the primary painful or uncomfortable sensations and the secondary mental/emotional reactions.
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Other useful directions:

This is about looking more at how you're identified with the content of thought. Many people feel a more intense self-referencing when getting caught up in reactivity, so it becomes "my very real thought about this very real me". The real 'cure' for this suffering is when you uproot the illusions that support all this mental behaviour. But even aside from uprooting the illusions at the root of this, (which are 'self-view' and 'Desire and ill-will'), it can be really useful to look at how it usually plays out.

The dynamic or mechanism of action you can observe if you slow it all down a bit and look is:
1) Painful or not pleasant sensations are experienced. There is the arising and ceasing of various sensations and contractions.
2) Next there is a movement away from the raw experience, as if to escape it. Thought usually kicks in and appropriates the experience as being owned by a 'self'. This concept then forms a narrative that enhances this attachment, and then greater emotion and tension arises as a result, further compounding the notion of a self.

If you simply observe in DE the sensations of discomfort (in relation to an unwanted fact), you can see that there isn't an inevitability about going into the thought narratives, and many assumptions about how things are can be dropped. Along with that much of the contraction or tension drops away too - what we're left with can be surprisingly different to what we normally experience or expect. We can also begin to see a bit of a gap appear between the primary sensations and whatever reactions normally follow.
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Separating these two aspects out (first and second dart responses) is something we use more in the Desire/Ill Will OR Attachment/aversion inquiry, but can be useful also for seeing the selfless or impersonal nature of what arises and how the “thoughts about” experience are the added on or ‘made up’ aspect, yet we tend to identify most strongly with this e.g.“My very real thoughts!"

Now, look at it in terms of direct experience. If you’re aware of or bring to mind something now that is an unwanted fact or issue, you’ll notice that ‘any primary’ pain is **always in direct experience now** –e.g. bodily pain, unpleasant sense experiences of any kind, heartache due to loss.

Secondary arrow pain suffering can follow that on and seem like it’s part of the first response, like a tail belonging to a dog… as if it’s an inevitable progression, but is in fact a mental abstraction away from the direct experience, manifesting as a “but I want” response in relation to that primary pain.
We feel we need/want ‘it’ (the issue, our basic feeling response - whatever it is) to be different. So, we worry about this happening / not happening, or fear this happening / not happening, etc. Perhaps self blaming or other resenting thoughts kick in.
Notice that these thoughts and further intensifications are often (usually) a pulling away from the primary experience and an attempt to resist it by creating an alternative reality.

In terms of this insight inquiry method, what you’re ‘getting in view’ experientially is, firstly, the direct experience just as it is – the ‘primary’ pain that’s actually present now.

Looking exercise #2

Take some space - about 5 mins is ideal - to just relax, being with any and all sensations.
Now have a look: In terms of direct experience – when there is just direct experience (physical sensations)– is there any ‘secondary’ proliferation present?

Now please bring to mind a ‘live’ issue or even a few issues for you right now, and form it as a sentence expressing an unwanted fact: Choose one such as (NOTE these are examples only - please create your own versions!).

“My father gives me advice ”
“Colleagues don’t ask how I am (or “say hello”)”
Let the sentence ‘percolate’ into experience, maybe by repeating it a few times. That is the basic fact.
Now watch for whatever particular sensations (including those of contraction) arise co-currently with the fact. Is there such a pain of body or heart present at this moment?
Focus on the sensation of that pain – turn towards it rather than our more usual response to block it out with thoughts / fantasies / doing something.
Notice whether there are such strategies arising, but don’t go with them – stay with / come back to the direct experience of the primary, perhaps unpleasant sensations.
Now – ‘look’ at the experience, i.e. simply allow it, be conscious of it, and try out these perspectives:

Are these sensations fixed or unchanging?
Can you have any control over whether it's 'there' or not?
Does "<<You>>" do (or create) the primary sensations?

Processing emotional conditioning/clearing up with EMDR

A Suggested Inquiry Approach

1. Pick a recurring first-dart traumatic experience. Bulleted list here on how to select it.
2. Tends to recur, feel stuck, incongruous responses, etc.response
3. Relive it a bit.
    1. What happened, to the best of your memory?
    2. What was your response at the time?
    3. What was the worst part of it? What did it reveal about you?
    4. What sensations, if any, arise in the body as you relive this experience? Are they reliably there when you bring this experience to mind?
4. Now, explore that aspect of YOU that was shown to be imperfect and/or not up to what life required in that experience.
    1. Seed this exploration with a silent ***"I wasn't (able to)…"*** and let the sentence/statement finish itself. Or, ***"I thought I was…"*** or ***"I should have been"*** or ***"I wanted to be seen as…"***.
    2. It's not that you didn't say or do something in particular: it's that you weren't ABLE to, based on who you were(n't).
    3. Even if you were a child and couldn't reasonably have been expected to do anything, what responsibility did you nevertheless take on?
    4. Be clear on the ***"I wasn't…"*** (or other wording) aspect/fact of it, and recognize it as a fact, however discomforting that was and still is.
    5. This is different from "I was…"
    6. The fact may trigger a familiar response/reaction (shudder, distraction, thought train, energy surge, etc.) - just notice what that response is.
5. Find the "gap" with this fact, holding in mind the fact and an image of the experience
    1. Watch for habitual reactions, and come back to the fact and image, and thus the gap, as necessary.
    2. Flood yourself with the fact that "I wasn't…", and also an image of the traumatic experience. In other words, don't just hold the "I wasn't…" fact in mind.
    3. If the fact changes, great! That means you are digging underneath the first estimate. For example, it may go from "I wasn't able to respond" to "I didn't know what I was doing". Continue on with that new fact as what that image is an example of.